

Lab Session 02

Portfolio - Typography & Color

Setup & Recap (10 mins)

- Recap lecture key points: font hierarchy, web fonts, accessible colors.
- Open portfolio Figma file (from Session 1).
- Create a **new page** named "02 – Typography & Color."

Create a Font System (25 mins)

Goal: Build typography variables for headings, body, and captions.

- Demo: fonts.google.com "You will always be mine" with different font choices
- Choose a font on fonts.google.com, Download necessary font-weights
 - Install on Mac: CMD + Space > "Font book" > Drag font files there
 - Install on Windows: Store font files under `C:\Windows\Fonts` or (If you can't move fonts there, use `C:\Users\Username\AppData\Local\Microsoft\Windows\Fonts\`)
- Font is now available in Figma
- Create Text Styles / Variables with consistent naming
 - Heading 1: type/h1
 - Heading 2: type/h2
 - Body / Paragraph: type/body
 - Caption / Meta: type/caption
- Try font variations: serif vs. sans-serif versions — observe readability differences.
- Apply the variables to their current portfolio homepage.
- 🧠 "Which font change had the biggest impact on your design's personality?"

Instructor Demo:

Show how changing a variable (e.g., Body font) updates the entire design.

Create and Test a Color System (30 mins)

Goal: Build color variables and ensure contrast accessibility.

- <https://coolors.co/>
- Define primary, secondary, neutral colors (use brand inspiration if available).
- Create Figma color variables for:
 - primary-500 ("default shade")
 - primary-200 ("lighter shade")
 - secondary-500
 - secondary-200
 - neutral-200
 - neutral-300
- Use the WebAIM Contrast Checker (or Figma color contrast check) to test:
 - Text on background
 - Button text on primary color
 - Adjust until AA (4.5:1) is reached for body text.

Instructor Demo:

- Show how a subtle tweak in brightness can make text pass AA.
- Show how to define tokens/variables for light and dark mode later.

Design a Project Detail Page (20 mins)

Goal: Apply all new text and color systems in a new layout.

- Create a new **frame/page** called "Project Detail."
 - Project title & subtitle
 - Image or mockup placeholder
 - Description text (paragraphs)
 - Links / buttons (e.g., "Visit Site," "Back to Overview")
- Use only **defined font & color variables** — no manual styles.
- Check all text/background combinations for contrast compliance.

Wrap-up (5 mins)

Quick reflection discussion

- "What was easiest?"
- "What contrast issue surprised you?"

Homework

Goal: Create a wireframe for portfolio home and project detail page. Desktop and mobile. Create color and typography styles. Design a Project Detail Page and apply created styles.

- Create a figma page **"01 - Wireframes"**
- Add wireframes for your portfolio homepage and a project detail page.
 - Just use simple boxes with text in it for the wireframe
 - Both pages should contain a main navigation and a page footer.
 - Each page should contain content blocks to get an idea what is shown where.
 - Don't "design" the blocks already, a wireframe is about information hierarchy and flow.
 - Desktop and mobile wireframes, so a total of 4 wireframes (Home Desktop, Home Mobile, Project Detail Desktop, Project Detail Mobile)
 - Create a wireframe for the mobile navigation (might look different than the desktop version)
- Create a new figma page **"02 - Styleguide"**
- Create color variables and typography styles. Demonstrate all typography style and colors on that page.
- Make sure contrasts meet WCAG AA.
- Create a new figma page **"02 - Project Detail Page"**
- Copy over your Project Detail Page (Desktop) wireframe and replace the blocks with actual content (can be fictional)
- Apply typography & color styles to that Project Detail Page
- Make sure **all used colors and typography should come from styles**, not "manually" declared.
- Select File > Save a local copy > Upload the .fig file to moodle